Who are you, really?

The space of mutual absence. Mutual implies two sides, and the untouched space, or space which has been left in between is also an open space of potential.

You are one side, what is the on other side? Your (ex)job, your (ex)partner, a friend, an ideal version of each? Another you? God? Is it the other side, or just the thought of the other side that creates the separation? This is the dynamic inside which we find our identity in all its fluidity and confusion.

The irony of consistency and change

We always look for consistency as we are looking for a stable and durable identity, but in a physical and mental world of impermanence, we are setting ourselves up for, ironically, a stable and durable conflict. The need for an anchor demands this. But navigating the conflict means awareness – firstly awareness that the conflict does indeed exist, secondly that we are part of it, and thirdly that progress and therefore potential lies in confrontation. The fluidity, the confusion, the fear lies in this space of mutual absence, and through confrontation of it all, so does potential.

We try to avoid confronting precisely what we don't want to confront, because we know it is in this confrontation where the confusion, the uncertainty, the despair and the fear lies waiting to be fully experienced. It is also here where we find ourselves stripped down to our absolute basics of identity, but it is also here where we get to find our real selves, without all the distractions. The real self is the product of this confrontation as it leads to understanding our motivations and our goals, and therefore also our direction and sense of meaning. Directionality is important in this construct - if we take out one from a full set, the rest crumbles. If we add one which didn't previously exist or got lost, we are building meaning.

How we define meaning and where we get it from forms the basis of our identity. Our identity is also based on our sense of self-esteem, self-efficacy and autonomy. If we can mesh this into the understanding of transformation and possibilities, we can find wisdom, and wisdom is the glue which connects all of this to life satisfaction and well-being.

So, who are you? Like really?

The Space of Mutual Absence: Where Potential Lives

The concept of mutuality implies two sides in a dynamic relationship. Yet, there exists an untouched space in between—an open space pregnant with potential. You are one side, but what lies on the other? Is it your (ex)job, (ex)partner, a close friend, or perhaps an ideal version of each? Maybe it's even another version of yourself, or something more intangible, like God. But is it really the "other side" that creates the division, or is it just the thought of that division itself? This tension between sides is where we forge our identity—fluid, confused, and constantly evolving.

The Paradox of Stability: Seeking Consistency in a World of Change

We are constantly searching for consistency—a stable, lasting identity. But in a world defined by impermanence, this search sets us up for an ironic conflict. In seeking stability, we inevitably create a tension between the need for permanence and the reality of change. This inner struggle plays out in our jobs, relationships, and sense of self. The desire for an anchor demands it. However, navigating this conflict requires awareness—awareness that the conflict exists, that we are part of it, and that true growth and potential lie in embracing it.

The Fear of Confrontation: Unveiling the Truth of Ourselves

We often avoid confronting what we fear most—because we know that within this confrontation lies confusion, uncertainty, despair, and fear, waiting to be fully experienced. But paradoxically, it is in this very space that we find ourselves stripped of distractions, exposed to the essence of our true identity. In the workplace, relationships, and within, this confrontation brings clarity about our motivations, goals, and ultimately, our direction in life. It is here, in the confrontation of discomfort, where we come face to face with our real self.

Direction and Meaning: Building a Life of Purpose

The process of confronting our fears and confusion provides us with more than just clarity—it brings us the foundation of meaning. Meaning is what shapes our identity and guides our direction. Directionality is important here. If we take out a vital piece, everything begins to falls apart. But when we rediscover or add what was missing, we begin to build something more substantial. Is this in the workplace and understanding your deeper motivations for your career path? In relationships, is it about rediscovering what truly matters and perhaps rebuilding your connections? This directionality isn't just about where we are going, but how we evolve along the way.

The Role of Self-Worth: Defining Identity and Possibilities

How we define meaning directly impacts how we define ourselves. Our identity is rooted in self-esteem, self-efficacy, and autonomy and meaning is absolutely central to each. In understanding this, we can find the most important kind of transformation – inner transformation. And this is where we find wisdom, the connective tissue between our inner world and outer life. And it is through wisdom that we align ourselves with well-being, life satisfaction, and the ability to navigate the complexities of work, relationships, and personal growth.

So, Who Are You?

Really, who are you? Beyond the roles you play in your job or relationships, who is the essence of you? In the space of mutual absence—where fear, confusion, and potential coexist, is there a deeper, more authentic version of yourself? When you confront the absence, you step into the fullness of who you are meant to be, and maybe, the fullness of who you always were.

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